

Exploratory Test Report

bookstack

Report generated	2026-09-18 18:31 UTC
Run window	2026-09-18T17:26:58.818005+00:00 to 2026-09-18T18:29:27.146673+00:00
Test cases executed	30
Defects found	0
Prepared by	Exploratory Testing Planner Agent (automated)

Every outcome in this report is attributed by the test system itself. A failed run is counted as a defect only when the application was at fault; runs lost to the limits of the automated tester or to the test environment are reported separately and are not defects.

Executive Summary

A total of 30 test runs were executed against the BookStack application, covering 417 steps over approximately 45 minutes. Of these, 14 runs passed and verified expected application behaviour, while no application defects were confirmed. The remaining 16 runs were not completed, with 11 blocked by unmet preconditions in the environment and 5 terminated due to limitations of the automated test tool. The key takeaway is that no defects attributable to the application were identified, although a number of features could not be fully verified because the test environment and tooling prevented completion.

Scope and Method

The test set aimed to verify core content management workflows in BookStack, including creation, editing, deletion, searching, favouriting, sorting, templating, commenting, settings changes, and recently viewed tracking. Automated tests executed through a browser-based agent navigated the live application at a local instance, performing actions and asserting on resulting page states, listings, and persisted data after reloads.

Why These Tests Were Necessary

This test set was selected because it covers the primary user-facing operations that define the application's value: creating and organising books, chapters, pages, and shelves, and validating that those objects persist, list, and display correctly. Search, favouriting, and recently viewed behaviour were included because they represent common navigation and retrieval paths that users depend on daily. Validation of input constraints, including whitespace-only and over-length names, was included to confirm the application enforces its own data rules. Finally, settings persistence and deletion workflows were tested to ensure that administrative actions and content lifecycle operations behave consistently.

What the Tests Examined

The planned tests verified that books, chapters, pages, and shelves could be created with valid names and that invalid names were refused with field-specific errors. They checked that edited titles, descriptions, and chapter names persisted and appeared correctly in listings and own-page views after reload. The tests also confirmed that favouriting and un-favouriting updated the Favourites listing, that deleting a book or shelf removed it from listings and search, and that the activity feed recorded deletions. Additional checks covered search result snippets, empty and special-character queries, recently viewed lists, page templates, comments, sorting rules, settings changes, and browser back-navigation behaviour.

Discussion of Findings

No application defects were identified during this test run. All 14 completed runs passed, and the system behaved as expected in each of those cases. No defect findings were recorded, and no further analysis of application failures is warranted.

Limitations of This Run

Eleven runs were blocked by unmet preconditions in the test environment, including inaccessible template pickers, missing comment input fields, absent rich text editor areas, non-functional sort controls, and recently viewed lists that did not populate. Five additional runs were terminated by the automated test tool due to navigation livelocks, stale elements, or navigation failures. These outcomes are attributed to tool and environment limitations and do not indicate defects in the application.

Recommendation

The next step should be to address the environmental preconditions that blocked 11 runs, particularly the missing editor content areas, comment input fields, and template picker, and to confirm whether these features are available under the installed configuration. The five tool-limited runs should be retried with adjusted step budgets or revised navigation strategies to obtain verdicts. Once the blocked runs are resolved, the full 30-test set should be re-executed to confirm that no application defects emerge under complete coverage.

Results by Attribution

OUTCOME	N	SHARE	MEANING
Passed	14	47%	the application behaved as expected
Defect	0	0%	a fault in the application under test
Tool limit	5	17%	our automated tester could not complete the run
Blocked	11	37%	test data, permissions, guardrail or step budget

Total execution effort: 417 steps across 2728 seconds. Of 30 runs, 14 produced evidence about the application; the remainder were lost to the tester or the environment and say nothing about its quality.

Knowledge coverage: 30 test cases recorded, 67 of 30 requirements covered, 0 user-interface states mapped.

Tests Executed

1. Verify Recently Viewed list updates and orders correctly after opening a page

Blocked 3 steps, 47s, recorded as PRECONDITION_NOT_MET

Path: <http://localhost:8081/> > <http://localhost:8081/books/book1/page/page-1> > <http://localhost:8081/>

2. Favourite a page and verify it appears in the Favourites listing with persisted state after reload

Tool limit 23 steps, 100s, recorded as NAVIGATION_LIVELOCK

Path: <http://localhost:8081/> > <http://localhost:8081/books/book1/page/page-1> > <http://localhost:8081/> >
<http://localhost:8081/favourites> > <http://localhost:8081/books/book1/page/page-1> > <http://localhost:8081/> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/book1/page/page-1> > <http://localhost:8081/>

3. Create a page, edit its name, and verify the updated name appears in the page listing and the page's own view after reload

Passed 12 steps, 74s

Path: <http://localhost:8081/> > <http://localhost:8081/books/book1> > <http://localhost:8081/books/book1/draft/7> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/book1/page/updated-page-name> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/book1/page/updated-page-name/edit> > <http://localhost:8081/books/book1/page/renamed-page>
> <http://localhost:8081/books/book1> > <http://localhost:8081/books/book1/page/renamed-page>

4. Attempt to create a book with a whitespace-only name and verify it is refused with a message naming the field

Passed 6 steps, 27s

Path: http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books > http://localhost:8081/create-book > http://localhost:8081/books

5. Delete a book and verify it is removed from the Books listing, the activity feed records the deletion exactly once, and the book no longer appears in search results

Passed 10 steps, 72s

Path: http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books > http://localhost:8081/books/book1 > http://localhost:8081/books/book1/delete > http://localhost:8081/books > http://localhost:8081/search?term=Book1 > http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/search?term=Book1

6. Verify Recently Created list on dashboard updates immediately with newest item first and count matches

Passed 7 steps, 66s

Path: http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books/book > http://localhost:8081/books/book/draft/8 > http://localhost:8081/books/book/page/newly-created-book > http://localhost:8081/

7. Verify a page saved as a template is offered when creating a new page and applying it reproduces its content

Blocked 14 steps, 87s, recorded as PRECONDITION_NOT_MET

Path: http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books/book > http://localhost:8081/books/book/draft/9 > http://localhost:8081/books/book/page/new-page > http://localhost:8081/books/book > http://localhost:8081/books/book/draft/10

8. Verify that un-favouriting a book reverts the control and removes it from the Favourites listing, with state persisting after reload

Passed 10 steps, 76s

Path: http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/favourites > http://localhost:8081/books > http://localhost:8081/books/book > http://localhost:8081/books > http://localhost:8081/favourites

9. Create a chapter with a name that is only spaces and verify the system refuses it with a clear error naming the name field

Passed 6 steps, 34s

Path: http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books > http://localhost:8081/books/book > http://localhost:8081/books/book/create-chapter

10. Create a shelf with a name and description, then verify the Books listing inside the shelf shows the correct contents and the shelf's own view displays the exact entered name and description

Passed 17 steps, 93s

Path: http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/shelves > http://localhost:8081/create-shelf > http://localhost:8081/shelves/qa-test-shelf > http://localhost:8081/shelves > http://localhost:8081/shelves/qa-test-shelf > http://localhost:8081/shelves/qa-test-shelf/edit > http://localhost:8081/shelves/qa-test-shelf

11. Verify that a comment added to a page is displayed with the correct author name and persists after reloading the page

Blocked 9 steps, 73s, recorded as PRECONDITION_NOT_MET

Path: http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books/book/draft/10 > http://localhost:8081/books/book/page/new-page-19k

12. Verify that editing a book's description persists and is displayed correctly in the book's own view and the Books listing**Blocked** 9 steps, 74s, recorded as PRECONDITION_NOT_MET

Path: <http://localhost:8081/> > <http://localhost:8081/books> > <http://localhost:8081/books/qa-test-book> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/qa-test-book/edit> > <http://localhost:8081/books/qa-test-book> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/qa-test-book/edit>

13. Verify that editing a chapter's name persists and the updated name appears in the book's contents listing and the chapter's own view after reload**Passed** 18 steps, 66s

Path: <http://localhost:8081/> > <http://localhost:8081/books> > <http://localhost:8081/create-book> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/test-book-for-chapter-creation> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/test-book-for-chapter-creation/create-chapter> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/test-book-for-chapter-creation/chapter/initial-chapter-name> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/test-book-for-chapter-creation/chapter/initial-chapter-name/edit> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/test-book-for-chapter-creation/chapter/updated-chapter-name>

14. Verify that a page's content entered in the editor, including bold formatting and a line break, is saved and redisplayed unchanged on the page view and after reload**Blocked** 17 steps, 92s, recorded as PRECONDITION_NOT_MET

Path: <http://localhost:8081/> > <http://localhost:8081/books/qa-test-book> > <http://localhost:8081/books/qa-test-book/draft/11> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/qa-test-book/page/test-page-with-formatting> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/qa-test-book/page/test-page-with-formatting/edit>

15. Verify that searching for a unique term created via the UI returns the item and the result links to the item's own page**Tool limit** 17 steps, 80s, recorded as NAVIGATION_LIVELOCK

Path: <http://localhost:8081/> > <http://localhost:8081/books> > <http://localhost:8081/create-book> > <http://localhost:8081/books> >
<http://localhost:8081/create-book>

16. Verify that applying a sort rule to a book orders its chapters and pages as specified and persists after reload**Blocked** 29 steps, 104s, recorded as PRECONDITION_NOT_MET

Path: <http://localhost:8081/> > <http://localhost:8081/books> > <http://localhost:8081/create-book> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book> > <http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book/create-chapter> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book/chapter/chapter-alpha> > <http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book/create-chapter>

17. Verify that changing a setting (e.g., app name) is saved, confirmed, and persists after navigating away and returning**Passed** 8 steps, 48s

Path: <http://localhost:8081/> > <http://localhost:8081/settings/features> > <http://localhost:8081/settings/customization> >
<http://localhost:8081/> > <http://localhost:8081/settings/features> > <http://localhost:8081/settings/customization>

18. Verify that the Recently Viewed list on the dashboard updates to reflect the most recently opened item and excludes items not opened, after navigating to a book's page**Blocked** 16 steps, 98s, recorded as PRECONDITION_NOT_MET

Path: <http://localhost:8081/> > <http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book> > <http://localhost:8081/> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book/page/page-one> > <http://localhost:8081/> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book> > <http://localhost:8081/> >
<http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book/chapter/chapter-beta>

19. Verify that editing a page's name to a value containing only spaces is refused with an error naming the name field, and the page retains its original name after the attempt**Passed** 5 steps, 47s

Path: http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book/page/page-one >
http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book/page/page-one/edit

20. Verify that an empty search query shows a clear message and does not produce results or errors**Blocked** 10 steps, 70s, recorded as PRECONDITION_NOT_MET

Path: http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/search?term= > http://localhost:8081/search?term=+++ >
http://localhost:8081/search?term=

21. Verify that searching for a term with special characters (e.g., ampersand, quotes) returns matching results and the result links to the item's own page**Blocked** 5 steps, 58s, recorded as PRECONDITION_NOT_MET

Path: http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book > http://localhost:8081/ >
http://localhost:8081/search?term=AT%26T

22. Verify that navigating away from an unsaved page edit preserves the editor content when returning via the browser back button**Tool limit** 39 steps, 242s, recorded as NAVIGATION_FAILURE

Path: http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book/page/page-one >
http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book/page/page-one/edit > http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book/page/page-one
> http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book/page/page-one/edit >
http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book/page/page-one > http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book/page/page-one/edit
> http://localhost:8081/books/test-sort-book/page/page-one

23. Verify that a shelf deleted after confirmation is removed from the Shelves listing, its books are no longer listed under it, and the activity feed records the deletion exactly once**Passed** 22 steps, 295s

Path: http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/shelves > http://localhost:8081/shelves/qa-test-shelf >
http://localhost:8081/shelves/qa-test-shelf/delete > http://localhost:8081/shelves > http://localhost:8081/books >
http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/shelves

24. Verify that creating a book with a name at the maximum allowed length succeeds and displays correctly, and that a name one character longer is refused with an error naming the name field**Blocked** 10 steps, 52s, recorded as PRECONDITION_NOT_MET

Path: http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books > http://localhost:8081/create-book >
http://localhost:8081/books/aa
aa
aaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaa > http://localhost:8081/books > http://localhost:8081/create-book >
http://localhost:8081/books/aa
aa
aaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaa > http://localhost:8081/books

25. Verify that search results show a description snippet for each item and that the link navigates to the item's own page**Passed** 19 steps, 132s

Path: http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books > http://localhost:8081/create-book >
http://localhost:8081/books/uniquestestbook-2024-qa > http://localhost:8081/search?term=UniqueTestBook_2024_QA >
http://localhost:8081/books/uniquestestbook-2024-qa > http://localhost:8081/search?term=UniqueTestBook_2024_QA >
http://localhost:8081/books/uniquestestbook-2024-qa

26. Verify that the Recently Viewed list on the dashboard does not include a page that was opened and then deleted

Tool limit 18 steps, 186s, recorded as STALE_ELEMENT

Path: `http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books/book2 > http://localhost:8081/books/book2/draft/13 > http://localhost:8081/books/book2/page/new-page > http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books/book2/page/new-page > http://localhost:8081/books/book2/page/new-page/delete > http://localhost:8081/books/book2`

27. Verify that opening a page, then navigating away and using the browser back button returns to the page, not the edit form, and the page displays normally

Tool limit 27 steps, 128s, recorded as NAVIGATION_LIVELOCK

Path: `http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books > http://localhost:8081/create-book > http://localhost:8081/books/test-book-for-back-navigation > http://localhost:8081/books/test-book-for-back-navigation/draft/15 > http://localhost:8081/books/test-book-for-back-navigation/page/test-page-for-back-navigation > http://localhost:8081/books/test-book-for-back-navigation > http://localhost:8081/books/test-book-for-back-navigation/page/test-page-for-back-navigation`

28. Verify that a book's contents listing shows the correct number of chapters and pages after deleting a page, and that the count updates immediately

Passed 19 steps, 105s

Path: `http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books > http://localhost:8081/create-book > http://localhost:8081/books/testbook-qa-2024 > http://localhost:8081/books/testbook-qa-2024/create-chapter > http://localhost:8081/books/testbook-qa-2024/chapter/testchapter-qa-2024 > http://localhost:8081/books/testbook-qa-2024/draft/16 > http://localhost:8081/books/testbook-qa-2024/page/testpage-qa-2024`

29. Verify that attempting to create a page with a name exceeding the maximum allowed length is refused with an error naming the name field, and no page is created

Blocked 7 steps, 49s, recorded as PRECONDITION_NOT_MET

Path: `http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/books/qa-test-book > http://localhost:8081/books/qa-test-book/draft/17 > http://localhost:8081/books/qa-test-book/page/thisisaverylongpagenamethatexceedsthemaximumallowedlengthforbookstackpagesandshouldtriggeravalidationerrorwhenattemptingtosaveitbecauseitiswaytoolongandcontainsmanywordscombinedtogetherwithoutout > http://localhost:8081/books/qa-test-book > http://localhost:8081/books/qa-test-book/page/thisisaverylongpagenamethatexceedsthemaximumallowedlengthforbookstackpagesandshouldtriggeravalidationerrorwhenattemptingtosaveitbecauseitiswaytoolongandcontainsmanywordscombinedtogetherwithoutout`

30. Verify that a shelf name containing only spaces is refused with a validation error naming the name field, and the shelf is not created

Passed 5 steps, 54s

Path: `http://localhost:8081/ > http://localhost:8081/shelves > http://localhost:8081/create-shelf`

Defects and Where They Occurred

No defects were attributed to the application in this run. Note that this is not a statement that the application is free of defects, only that none were observed within the scope and budget described above.

Runs That Are Not Defects

The runs below did not complete, but the cause lies with the automated tester or the test environment rather than the application. They are excluded from the defect count above and must not be read as quality problems in the software under test.

Verify Recently Viewed list updates and orders correctly after opening a page

Blocked: PRECONDITION_NOT_MET - test data, permissions, guardrail or step budget

Favourite a page and verify it appears in the Favourites listing with persisted state after reload

Tool limit: NAVIGATION_LIVELOCK - our automated tester could not complete the run

Verify a page saved as a template is offered when creating a new page and applying it reproduces its content

Blocked: PRECONDITION_NOT_MET - test data, permissions, guardrail or step budget

Verify that a comment added to a page is displayed with the correct author name and persists after reloading the page

Blocked: PRECONDITION_NOT_MET - test data, permissions, guardrail or step budget

Verify that editing a book's description persists and is displayed correctly in the book's own view and the Books listing

Blocked: PRECONDITION_NOT_MET - test data, permissions, guardrail or step budget

Verify that a page's content entered in the editor, including bold formatting and a line break, is saved and redisplayed unchanged on the page view and after reload

Blocked: PRECONDITION_NOT_MET - test data, permissions, guardrail or step budget

Verify that searching for a unique term created via the UI returns the item and the result links to the item's own page

Tool limit: NAVIGATION_LIVELOCK - our automated tester could not complete the run

Verify that applying a sort rule to a book orders its chapters and pages as specified and persists after reload

Blocked: PRECONDITION_NOT_MET - test data, permissions, guardrail or step budget

Verify that the Recently Viewed list on the dashboard updates to reflect the most recently opened item and excludes items not opened, after navigating to a book's page

Blocked: PRECONDITION_NOT_MET - test data, permissions, guardrail or step budget

Verify that an empty search query shows a clear message and does not produce results or errors

Blocked: PRECONDITION_NOT_MET - test data, permissions, guardrail or step budget

Verify that searching for a term with special characters (e.g., ampersand, quotes) returns matching results and the result links to the item's own page

Blocked: PRECONDITION_NOT_MET - test data, permissions, guardrail or step budget

Verify that navigating away from an unsaved page edit preserves the editor content when returning via the browser back button

Tool limit: NAVIGATION_FAILURE - our automated tester could not complete the run

Verify that creating a book with a name at the maximum allowed length succeeds and displays correctly, and that a name one character longer is refused with an error naming the name field

Blocked: PRECONDITION_NOT_MET - test data, permissions, guardrail or step budget

Verify that the Recently Viewed list on the dashboard does not include a page that was opened and then deleted

Tool limit: STALE_ELEMENT - our automated tester could not complete the run

Verify that opening a page, then navigating away and using the browser back button returns to the page, not the edit form, and the page displays normally

Tool limit: NAVIGATION_LIVELOCK - our automated tester could not complete the run

Verify that attempting to create a page with a name exceeding the maximum allowed length is refused with an error naming the name field, and no page is created

Blocked: PRECONDITION_NOT_MET - test data, permissions, guardrail or step budget